



AIS

ENHANCE COACH PROGRAM

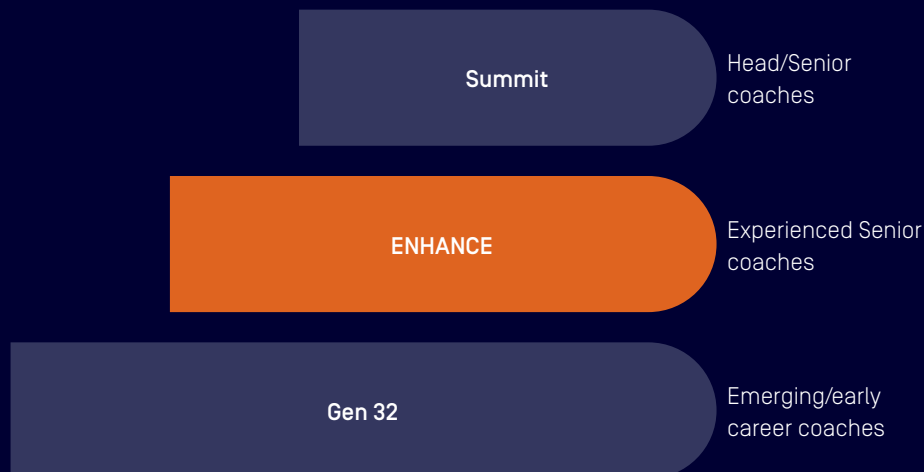
ENHANCE Coach Program

Outstanding coaching is a fundamental driver of Australia's sporting success. Through the HP Coach Development Program, the Australian Institute of Sport [AIS] is committed to supporting HP coaches to continually learn, evolve and lead within an increasingly complex high performance system.

The ENHANCE Coach Program is an 18-month learning and development initiative designed for **experienced Australian high performance [HP] coaches**. In its second iteration, ENHANCE provides HP coaches with an opportunity to advance their knowledge, skills and coaching across a range of areas inclusive of self-awareness, leadership, conflict resolution and systems thinking ensuring they can effectively contribute to the Australian HP sport's vision to "Win Well to inspire Australians."

The 2027–2028 program will be delivered in a world leading partnership with the **University of Technology Sydney**, offering coaches the opportunity to work towards a Graduate Certificate in High-Performance Sport. This partnership reflects the depth, quality and rigour of the ENHANCE learning experience.

AIS Programs: Selected HP coaches



"Our Australian coaches are world leading and investing in their ongoing development and leadership is extremely important for sports and the national sporting system.

The ENHANCE program creates the opportunity for experienced coaches to come together, learning from each other's successes and challenges, and understanding best practices from across sports."

Andrew Faichney
General Manager, Australian Athletics



ENHANCE PROGRAM PURPOSE

The ENHANCE Coach Program is designed to build the capability of Australia's experienced HP coaches, empowering them to thrive as people, leaders and enablers of sustained performance.

MISSION STATEMENT

To develop and support experienced HP coaches [~5-10 years+] by providing opportunities to strengthen leadership, strategic, and collaborative skills, ensuring they can effectively contribute to the Australian HP sport's vision to "win well to inspire Australians."

QUICK PROGRAM FACTS



24

PROGRAM
COHORT SIZE



18

MONTHS PROGRAM DURATION

Aligned with competition
and funding cycles



Jan 2027

PROGRAM
COMMENCEMENT



5

ON-CAMPUS RESIDENTIALS

1 x 3-day introduction
3 x 4-day residentials
1 x 2-day post
Los Angeles debrief



LOCATION

for all program residentials

\$4-5K

APPROXIMATE COSTS

Estimated travel costs
which are at the expense of
NSO/D & NIN (airfares, accom,
ground transport)

Why ENHANCE?

As a participating coach, you will:

- ➔ Gain a deeper understanding of **self** and how that influences your coaching
- ➔ Develop your **leadership philosophy**, style and practice
- ➔ Build confidence in innovative leadership methods to **influence**, lead and develop others
- ➔ Extend and challenge your **critical thinking** and decision-making abilities
- ➔ Fine tune and clearly articulate your **strategic intent**
- ➔ Develop a system-wide view and enhance your **knowledge** of the HP system
- ➔ Broaden your network and connections to better operate within and leverage the Australian HP system
- ➔ Create collaborative HP teams and **high-performing environments**

As part of the cohort, you will:

- > Learn from seasoned leaders as well as fellow experienced HP coach peers
- > Benefit from dedicated learning leaders in 1:1 and small group formats
- > Build connections with coaches and system leaders, creating long-lasting relationships and support networks
- > Be challenged to critically reflect on your coaching and identify opportunities to innovate
- > Benefit from a peer cohort selected to maximise group dynamics and encourage a diversity of perspectives

As a supporting organisation, you will:

- > Benefit from the development of experienced coaches to lead with purpose, navigate change and strategically respond to future challenges
- > Gain practical coaching solutions and insights from cross-sport learnings to positively impact daily performance environments
- > Maintain coach roles while simultaneously supporting their development, increasing likelihood of retention and job satisfaction





“

“The Enhance Coach Program has come at a pivotal stage in my development as a coach, leader and person. As an experienced high performance sport leader, I had developed ways of operating that were effective but increasingly familiar. At times, this led me to default to reacting quickly, challenging viewpoints and advocating strongly for outcomes I believed were right.

Through this program, I have significantly expanded both my skillset and self-awareness. I have learned the value of patience, allowing processes to unfold and recognising that influence is often more effective than immediate action. I am now more comfortable ensuring my perspective is heard while also constructively supporting organisational decisions, even when they differ from my initial view.

I consider the Enhance Coach Program to be career-defining. It has strengthened my leadership capability, broadened my perspective and enhanced my ability to operate effectively within complex high performance environments. Most importantly, it has equipped me to continue making a meaningful contribution to my sport and the broader high performance system for many years to come.”

David Reid

Enhance Coach Program and High Performance Relays Lead,
Australian Athletics

What you'll learn

The program is built around three interconnected focus areas. Every aspect of the program is expert-facilitated and grounded in real coaching challenges



1. Leadership & Self Awareness

Develop emotional intelligence, ethical leadership and reflective practice, while fostering psychological safety within high performance environments.



2. Communication & Coaching

Strengthen communication, conflict management and decision making capabilities, using evidenceinformed strategies to effectively support people and performance.



3. Systems Thinking in High Performance Environments

Build capability in navigating high performance systems through strategic partnerships, systemlevel thinking and organisational alignment.



“

Being part of the AIS Enhance programme has been a truly transformative experience. The guidance, opportunities, and encouragement I received have strengthened my confidence, expanded my knowledge, and prepared me for the future.

Shane Perkins

Head Coach - Cycling WAIS



Key learning outcomes

1 Self-Awareness & Emotional Intelligence

Leading with Emotional Intelligence

Understand how your emotional intelligence shapes the way you coach and lead. Develop self-awareness and self-regulation strategies that build genuine trust and bring out the best in those around you.

2 Leadership Style & Accountability

Knowing Your Leadership Identity

Reflect honestly on your leadership strengths and blind spots. Drawing on real feedback and a range of leadership styles, define what authentic, accountable leadership looks like for you - and how to inspire trust in others.

3 Wellbeing & Resilience

Sustaining Yourself to Sustain Others

Explore practical wellbeing and resilience strategies to help you perform at your best, while supporting athletes and coaches through the pressures of high performance sport.

4 Psychological Safety

Creating Environments Where People Thrive

Learn how to embed psychological safety into your coaching practice. Develop approaches that foster belonging, inclusion and wellbeing, so people feel safe to perform, take risks and grow.

5 Communication

Communicating to Connect and Inspire

Build individual and group communication skills to better engage athletes, share knowledge effectively and strengthen the collaborative dynamics that underpin high performance teams.

6 Conflict & Difficult Conversations

Navigating Conflict with Confidence

Gain structured frameworks for managing conflict and holding difficult conversations - whether between athletes, within coaching teams or across the broader high performance environment - turning tension into progress.



ENHANCE is a program where we all rise together, by creating a trusted community where high performance coaches support, challenge, and learn from one another, we strengthen the individual, elevate the profession, and shape the next generation of coaching leaders.

Harley Connolly

Head Coach, Para Hub Swimming Australia

7 High Performance Environments

Building a Culture That Performs

Explore what separates good environments from great ones. Examine the evidence behind high performance cultures and apply practical strategies to lift standards, dynamics and culture within your program.

8 Ethics & Decision Making

Making the Right Call Under Pressure

Sharpen your ethical decision-making and critical thinking skills for moments that matter most. Learn how to stay grounded in your values when pressure is high and choices are complex.

9 Systems & Politics

Understanding the HP System Around You

Map the structures, politics and power dynamics of the Australian high performance system. Identify where and how you can influence performance, wellbeing and culture - beyond your immediate program.

10 Stakeholder Engagement

Building Strategic Partnerships

Develop a stakeholder engagement plan that strengthens key relationships, enhances collaboration and enables you to work effectively within the high performance system.

11 Systems Thinking

Solving Problems at Scale

Step back to see the bigger picture. Develop system-level thinking to design smarter solutions, address root causes and optimise coaching effectiveness and program outcomes.

12 Coaching Philosophy & Strategy

Aligning Your Philosophy with Your Program

Connect your personal coaching philosophy to your program's vision, goals and priorities. Use strategic frameworks to align what you stand for with what your program needs, and lead with clarity and conviction.



The ENHANCE Coach Program provides coaches with a framework to reflect, recalibrate and refine individual coaching practices and leadership capacity. The leadership circle is a game changer in developing individual leadership capabilities, and has provided me the tools to navigate the pressures that come with high performance sport, and show up consistently regardless of the situation.

Shannon Fraser

Assistant Coach, Australian Men's Rugby 7s, Rugby Australia

Structure and delivery

Program delivery

The ENHANCE Coach Program is practical and applied. Delivery includes:

- > Four residential learning blocks held at the AIS
- > A post Los Angeles Olympic Games reflection opportunity
- > Frequent and ongoing facilitated Communities of Practice in small groups
- > Three whole-of-cohort half-day online sessions
- > 1:1 Leadership Circle Profile assessment and debriefs
- > Frequent ongoing 1:1 Learning Leader discussions
- > Applied workplace and experiential learning

Facilitation

The program is coordinated and led by the AIS High Performance Coach Development team.

Two lead facilitators guide the program end-to-end, bringing extensive high performance coaching, leadership and system-level expertise, alongside strong facilitation capability.

Learning Leaders - including Coach Development Leads from across Australia - support participants throughout the program. They facilitate all one-to-one meetings and small-group online sessions, and act as a key link between participants and their sport's Performance Director or High Performance Manager.

Leadership Circle Profile™

Every participant completes the Leadership Circle Profile™ (LCP) - one of the world's most sophisticated 360-degree leadership assessments. It reveals the relationship between your inner beliefs and your outer leadership behaviours, giving you a clear picture of where you're at and where your greatest opportunities for growth lie. Results are unpacked with expert facilitation, connecting directly to your Individual Coach Development Plan (ICDP).

What It Measures

The assessment provides a comprehensive view of your leadership impact, including:

- > 360-degree feedback from peers, athletes and key stakeholders
- > Insight into creative versus reactive leadership patterns
- > Understanding the connection between inner beliefs and observable behaviour
- > Benchmarking against global high performance leadership standards

What You Receive

Participants gain targeted, practical insights through:

- > An expert debrief with certified facilitators
- > A clear link between results and personal development priorities
- > Insights that directly inform your ICDP
- > A strong foundation for ongoing self-reflection and growth

Individual Coach Development Plan (ICDP)

Alongside your LCP results, you'll build a personalised Individual Coach Development Plan — a living document that translates self-awareness and program learning into concrete actions. Your ICDP is yours to own and revisit throughout the program and beyond.

- 1 Identify your most significant development priorities
- 2 Set clear, time-bound actions connected to real challenges
- 3 Align your personal coaching philosophy with the strategic direction of your HP program
- 4 Track your growth with Learning Leader check-ins and facilitated peer review throughout the program
- 5 Leave with a plan you can take back to your organisation and continue developing

Program Design Principles

The Program is designed on the basis of the following key principles:



1. Collaborative & Social Learning

The program promotes knowledge sharing, collaboration and networking to enhance learning across the coaching community.



2. Connection

Build a strong sense of belonging by recognising and respecting individual needs, motivations and aspirations.



3. Performance & Wellbeing

Prioritise the physical, mental, emotional and cultural wellbeing of both coaches and athletes within high performance environments.



4. Practical application

Learning is practical and immediately applicable, enabling coaches to experiment, adapt and apply insights within their unique sporting context.



5. Diverse perspectives

Foster an inclusive environment that values, respects and leverages diverse experiences, backgrounds and viewpoints.



I have seen the value of the ENHANCE Program first-hand through coaches at the VIS. In an athlete-centred, coach-led environment, we ask coaches to do so much more than simply coach; they are leading people, managing complex relationships and bringing teams together around performance. ENHANCE gives them the space, support and skills to continue growing into those leadership demands.

Hannah Every-Hall

General Manager High Performance, VIS

Recognised Prior Learning via University of Technology Sydney

Since the inception of the ENHANCE Coach Program, significant work has been done in working towards establishing a partnership with an Australian University to investigate the possibility of how the program can be elevated towards a nationally recognised qualification.

The AIS is finalising a partnership arrangement that, from the 2027–2028 cohort, will enable participants who successfully complete the ENHANCE Coach Program to receive Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) towards a nationally recognised qualification.

Subject to meeting specified attendance and assessment criteria, coaches will be eligible to receive 50% Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) of the Graduate Certificate in High Performance Sport through the University of Technology Sydney (UTS).

Assessment requirements will vary but will include maintaining a personal journal to capture development opportunities, key learnings and experiences. Journals are not required to be shared but will help form the basis of the coach's final presentation.

Entry and selection into the Program are not bound by a coach's decision to pursue the UTS Graduate Certificate in High Performance Coaching.



Coach Eligibility

Coaches with a desire to enter the ENHANCE Coach Program must meet the following criteria:

- Be currently employed or contracted by an NSO, NSOD or NIN as a HP coach; AND have a minimum 5+ years' experience; AND currently be coaching athletes competing in senior international competition.
- Be considered by the NSO/D and/or NIN as highly likely to deliver athletes to the Australian Los Angeles Olympic/Paralympic team and/or coach within the Los Angeles Olympic/Paralympic team environment. AND/OR
- Be considered by the NSO/D and/or NIN as highly likely to deliver athletes to the Australian French Alps Winter Olympic/Paralympic team and/or coach within the French Alps Winter Olympic/Paralympic environment.
- Be considered by the NSO/D and/or NIN as highly likely to deliver athletes to the 2030 Australian Ahmedabad Commonwealth Games team and/or coach within the Ahmedabad Commonwealth Games environment.
- Be committed to pursuing HP coaching as an ongoing career of choice.

Additionally, Coach applicants must:

- Be an Australian citizen or hold permanent residence status
- Be available for all mandatory program components and dates
- Hold a current Working with Vulnerable People (relevant State/Territory) where applicable
- Agree to be bound by the Integrity policies, Code of Conduct, Code of Ethics, and anti-doping policies of the ASC, and relevant NSO/D and NIN partner
- Meet all SIA and AIS Integrity requirements



Coaches are central to achieving Australia's Win Well 2032+ High Performance Sport outcomes. By creating environments where coaches can thrive, we enable them to maximise their positive impact on athletes, on and off the field of play. One thing I love about the AIS Enhance Program is the way it fits into a suite of learning for coaches so they are supported throughout their coaching careers.

Keren Faulkner

Director, South Australian Sports Institute

FAQ

Who is responsible for program costs?

All travel costs — including flights to and from Canberra, ground transport and accommodation in Canberra — are covered by the NSO/D or NIN. With five trips to the AIS over 18 months, estimated travel costs are approximately \$4,000–\$5,000 per coach. All other program costs are covered by the AIS.

Is attendance at all residential compulsory?

Yes. Attendance at all residential is compulsory as they are fundamental to the program. Residential are scheduled during periods traditionally favourable for attendance. Circumstances that prevent attendance will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

What is the program journal and is it a requirement?

Yes. Coaches must maintain and present a program journal at the conclusion of the 18 months. The journal documents personal growth and development relevant to their coaching career and is also required for any credentials or certification to be awarded.

Is NSO/D or NIN endorsement required?

Yes. Endorsement by your NSO/D or NIN is required for program entry, along with financial support to attend the residential blocks.

What if I change roles during the program?

While the program is designed for HP coaches we recognise that changes can occur. Continuation will be considered on a case-by-case basis. The content is transferable to other roles within the Australian HP landscape.

What level of HP coach is the program aimed at?

The program is designed for experienced coaches with significant international coaching experience, typically 5–10+ years in HP coaching roles.

Does involvement in other AIS Coach Development Programs preclude application?

No. We are open to applications from coaches involved in other programs such as Summit or the Coach Mentorship Program. We will seek information on how ENHANCE will add value to your coaching and development.

Are graduates of the historical Podium Coach Program eligible to apply?

Yes, however you will need to present a case for how ENHANCE will add further value to your coaching and development.

Is employment with an NSO/D or NIN required?

Not strictly, but it is expected. In sports where senior coaches are typically volunteers [e.g. many para sports], coaches will be considered if they meet the experience criteria, coach senior athletes in international competition, and are endorsed and financially supported by their NSO/D/NIN.

For additional information, refer to the program information including guidelines and selection criteria or contact hpcoachdevelopment@ausport.gov.au



The AIS ... provided incredible mentors to guide and support us throughout the journey, and tools to build a more strategic mindset. I came out of this with a better understanding of the Australian sporting system, genuine connections with some amazing coaches and reflecting deeply about the kind of coach I was aspiring to be. The most valuable thing I have done for my coaching development.

Taip Ramadani

Senior Men's Head Coach, Handball Australia

APPENDIX 1

The Australian High Performance Coach Development Framework



APPENDIX 2

HP strategic alignment

The AIS has a strong track record of delivering transformative development opportunities for HP coaches and continues to prioritise coach development in its HP 2032+ Win Well Sport Strategy and the National HP Coach Development Strategy.

The ENHANCE Coach Program directly supports the development of experienced HP coaches as enabled, empowered and supported leaders of sustainable sporting success. The program fosters capabilities that aim to ensure coaches are equipped to create HP environments that prioritise both excellence and wellbeing. By embedding a culture of continuous learning and innovation, ENHANCE strengthens Australia's coaching workforce to ensure that coaches are not only driving medal success but also contributing to a positive and ethical sporting culture.

WIN+
WELL





Australian Government

Australian Sports Commission



[AIS.gov.au](https://ais.gov.au)



@theAIS #theAIS

Leverrier Street Bruce ACT 2617
PO BOX 176 Belconnen ACT 2616
+61 2 6214 1111